

GROUP O

Group Kickoff Meeting

Minutes — 18 August 2026

Project title	Multi-Site Smart Soil and Environmental Monitoring System
Meeting	Group kickoff
Date	18 August 2026
Time	14:00 – 15:00
Venue	Central University of Technology, Free State
Chair	Caitlin Freeman
Minutes taken by	Tiisetso Masita
Document reference	MIN-01

1. Attendance

Name	Student number	Role	Present
Nido Maphosa	223039784	Tech Lead / SRS Compiler / Full-Stack Developer	Yes
Caitlin Freeman	224097774	Project Manager / Frontend Developer	Yes
Mbasa Tyam	222056708	Backend Developer / Frontend Design	Yes
Tiisetso Masita	223043636	SRS Compiler / Frontend Developer	Yes
Machedi Mamello	222001607	SRS Compiler	Yes
Ayatolla Pikwa	224135694	SRS Compiler / Designer	Yes
Katlontle Seiphetlho	224130045	Frontend Developer	Yes
Thobani Mjiyakho	222088478	SRS Compiler / Software Developer	Yes

All eight members were present. No apologies were recorded.

2. Agenda

1. Confirmation of group membership
2. Allocation of roles and ownership of deliverables
3. Ways of working and meeting cadence
4. Tools, repository and confidentiality rules
5. Approach to identifying an external stakeholder
6. Actions and next meeting

3. Discussion

3.1 Group membership and roles

Eight members were confirmed, within the range of six to ten permitted for the module. Role allocation was discussed against two separate needs: the interview roles required during stakeholder engagement, and ownership of the artefacts the project must produce.

It was agreed that role titles would carry real ownership rather than being nominal. Each artefact — the specification, the schedule, the repository — would have one named owner accountable for it, while the work itself remains shared. The group noted that a member's name appearing only on a cover page is not acceptable evidence of contribution, and that every member would need recorded work with evidence attached.

3.2 Ways of working

A fixed weekly progress meeting was agreed, with additional working sessions called as needed. The group agreed that decisions taken in any meeting would be recorded with a reference number so that they could be traced later, and that actions would carry a named owner and a due date rather than being assigned to the group generally.

3.3 Tools and confidentiality

The technology set is prescribed and is not open to substitution: Flutter for the mobile application, ASP.NET MVC for the web application, and Supabase as the shared backend. Microsoft Project and a version-controlled repository are compulsory for planning and for source control respectively.

The group agreed that all project documentation would live in the repository alongside the source code, in a documentation folder, and that no telephone number, identity number, password, API key or confidential stakeholder record would be committed at any point. It was noted that removing a file in a later commit does not remove a credential from the repository history, and that an exposed key must be rotated rather than merely deleted.

3.4 Stakeholder search

The project requires a real external stakeholder with a real problem. The group agreed that candidates would be assessed on whether the problem was genuine and currently unsolved, whether it required both a mobile and a web application over a shared backend, and whether it could realistically be scoped to one semester.

An approach to the Department of Agriculture at the institution was identified as the most promising, on the basis that soil monitoring equipment was understood to be already deployed.

4. Decisions

Ref	Decision
D01	Roles allocated as recorded in section 1: Nido Maphosa as technical lead, Caitlin Freeman as project manager, Mbasa Tyam on backend, with specification and frontend work shared across the remaining members.
D02	A fixed weekly progress meeting is held, with additional working sessions called as required.
D03	One version-controlled repository holds both project documentation and source code.
D04	No member's name appears on a submission without recorded work and attached evidence.
D05	No confidential stakeholder information, credential or personal identifier is committed to the repository at any point.
D06	Every decision taken in a meeting is recorded with a reference number, and every action carries one named owner and a due date.
D07	The Department of Agriculture is approached as the prospective stakeholder.

5. Actions

Ref	Action	Owner	By	Status
A01	Create the repository, add a README and a .gitignore, and invite all eight members	Nido Maphosa	24 Aug 2026	Complete
A02	Create the Supabase account, organisation and project	Mbasa Tyam	24 Aug 2026	Complete
A03	Approach the Department of Agriculture and confirm a stakeholder	Mbasa Tyam	19 Aug 2026	Complete
A04	Set up the Microsoft Project schedule across the three phases	Caitlin Freeman	27 Aug 2026	Complete
A05	Prepare questions for the first stakeholder consultation	Tiisetso Masita	19 Aug 2026	Complete

6. Next Meeting

Purpose	Stakeholder consultation — scope, architecture and timeline
Date	19 August 2026
Attending	All eight members, with one member speaking on behalf of the group
Record	MIN-02, held with the project records

Record completed by

Tiisetso Masita on 18 August 2026, and reviewed by Caitlin Freeman as chair.